

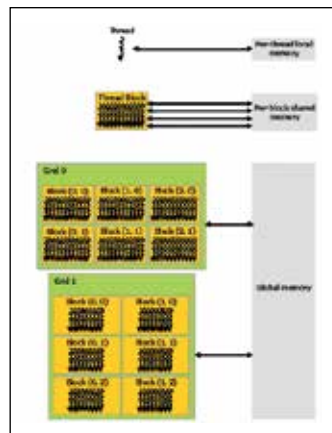
ones that are more used in our day to day life (e.g. VLC Media Player) do not use GPU all that much.

More wisdom for more efficient GPUs

Just because a GPU is more powerful than the other, does not mean you should always get a better one. The key factors are your budget, the amount of graphics load you would put on it (gaming and 3D modelling are more intensive than image editing). If your needs are minimal, go for a basic model and please do not be misguided by the amount of memory the chip has.

The important parts of the spec-sheet are:

1. **Number of stream processors:** The number of processors on the GPU to calculate on the graphics data. These are also known as ‘cores’ or ‘shaders’. The terminology is such because of their historic use of processing a 3D world rendering where they calculated the color (or ‘shade’) of pixels. Since some time now, pioneered by NVIDIA, they can be used by some general purpose programs to offload some specific types of calculations. The technology is termed ‘CUDA’ by NVIDIA and they call the same ‘CUDA cores’. The higher this number, the better the card is.
2. **The GPU clock speed:** This one is the speed at which the GPU would run and is analogous to the core clock speed of a CPU. The higher it is, the more powerful and power hungry your GPU would be.
3. **Memory frequency:** The speed at which the dedicated GPU memory operates. The higher the better. If you look at spec-sheets of manufacturer websites, chances are you will get confused because sometimes they mention the memory frequency in ‘Gbps’. That would be the data transfer rate which is 4 times the memory frequency. Memory frequencies are measured in MHz and should range between 1200 to 2000 MHz.
4. **Memory Size:** Though we have told you that memory size is not the only parameter to rank GPUs, they do come in picture and if you can, get



NVIDIA GPU memory hierarchy